

investment company, but they don't have the time, don't have the expertise, or are too emotional to manage their own money. Would you represent yourself in court? Fix your own plumbing? Give yourself medical advice? For specialized advice, we normally go to a specialist.

If there are so many advantages to working with a specialist, why then do so many people choose to invest their own money without seeking advice? A common answer is to save on commission charges. Remember though, the purpose of investing is to make money. Ask yourself the question, "Does the commission fee offset the performance of an identified high-quality fund and the lessening of mistakes when made by a professional?" Or another question, "What is it worth to you to achieve your goals?" Depending on your answer to these questions, it may make sense to have a professional investing your money. This is especially true if you tend to react emotionally in regards to your money.

Words of Wisdom

Investing is probably the most complicated and confusing of all the money management skills discussed in this book. However, the skill of investing wisely is arguably one of the most important. Without investing at all or investing naively, you will be certain to have financial goals that are never reached and a retirement that is not funded adequately. With such high stakes, you should seriously consider adopting the lessons in this chapter:

- Get over your fear of investing.
- Realize that every experience does not have to be a negative one.
- Understand your various investment options.
- Do not chase the latest "hot" stock.
- Do not panic and sell when the market goes through fluctuations.

